Burndown Chart Reflection

Burndown Chart

SPRINT 3 BURNDOWN CHART
[Figure 1: Jira burndown — Sprint 3 (previous sprint) (Mar 9 – Mar 22, 2026). Estimation: story points.]

SPRINT 4 BURNDOWN CHART
[Figure 2: Jira burndown — Sprint 4 (Mar 25– April 5, 2026). Estimation: story points.]

Reading the chart — Sprint 4 (story points)

The grey guideline is the ideal burn: remaining story points should decrease smoothly from the opening backlog to zero by the last day of the sprint. The red line shows our actual remaining work.

Starting point. The sprint opened with roughly 18.5–19 story points of committed work, which aligns with the 19 story points shown on the sprint backlog.

- Mar 25–Mar 28. The red line stays essentially flat at the top. In practice, that usually means the team was still integrating or testing, user stories were large enough that none had reached Done yet, or Jira was not updated even if partial progress existed.
- Mar 29–Mar 30. The line steps down in small increments (from about 18.5 toward 13). That indicates the first stories were completed and burned off story points, but the burn was still slow relative to the guideline.
- Mar 30–Apr 3. The remaining work is flat at about 13 story points for several days. For most of this window we were above the ideal line—i.e. behind the planned burn rate. Common causes include large or end-to-end stories, merge and integration work, testing batching, blockers that were only cleared late, or limited contiguous dev time (e.g. coursework or exams), matching the mid-sprint plateau pattern we saw in Sprint 3.
- Apr 4. There is a sharp drop (from about 13 to about 3 in a single day). That pattern is typical when multiple stories flip to Done together after integration or QA, rather than incrementally day by day—a hockey-stick burndown.
- Apr 5. Remaining work reaches zero. All work committed for Sprint 4 was completed by sprint close.

Planned velocity vs. actual (Sprint 4)
Planned pace: The grey guideline embodies the planned rate of progress: a linear reduction from the first day's remaining points to zero by Apr 5.
Actual pace: The red line follows the day-by-day remaining story points described above: it is almost smooth and a short mid-sprint plateau.
Conclusion: For most of the sprint we tracked above the guideline (behind the ideal burn), but we still finished with zero remaining story points. So the outcome met the sprint goal (everything delivered).

Sprint velocity vs. previous sprint
Sprint 3 (from our earlier burndown, story points). The guideline started around nine story points, but actual remaining work jumped soon after sprint start (roughly 19–31, peaking near 37), stayed flat for much of the middle, then fell sharply on the last day (with a brief spike toward 40 before reaching zero). That shape reflects scope growth after planning, large stories, and batched completion/status updates toward the deadline.

Sprint 4. By contrast, the opening backlog is stable at about 19 story points (~18.5 on the chart); we do not see the same early explosion in remaining work that Sprint 3 showed. The shape of the two sprints is still similar in spirit: a plateau in the middle and drop near the end, and both sprints end at zero.

Any changes and reasons why - velocity
Sprint 4 looks healthier on scope discipline. We did not repeat Sprint 3's large early spike in remaining story points, so the sprint backlog stayed much closer to what we committed at planning. Overall, the Sprint 4 burndown is flatter and more stable than Sprint 3's curve—it does not swing as violently (for example, we did not see a late jump toward ~40 points immediately before hitting zero). We still had slower progress in the middle of the sprint and

more completion toward the end, but the pattern feels more controlled, without the same kind of sharp, last-minute collapse that made Sprint 3’s chart look so uneven.